

Neighbours **PAKISTAN**



March of the **TALIBAN**

A peace agreement between Islamabad and a pro-Taliban militia in Pakistan's Swat Valley signals a loss of control and sets off warning bells across the region

| By Hasan Zaidi in Karachi |

The arrival of Maulana Sufi Mohammad on February 17 at a dusty Mingora ground, at the head of a caravan of some 300 cars, saw hundreds of people thronging to catch a glimpse of the white-bearded and turbaned old man who could perhaps bring peace to the brutalised Swat Valley, where armed militants and Pakistani forces have been battling it out for over a year. A 10-day ceasefire announced a day earlier by the militants and a lifting of military curfews had